Gaza population has, according to the Health Ministry, suffered some 3,800 deaths from Israeli Air Force attacks. Unfortunately, the ground offensive cannot take place without exacting many more human lives, on both sides.

Sunday, October 22

The summit meeting in Cairo of European and Arab countries, convened by Egyptian president el-Sisi to find a solution to the crisis, ended without any resolution because the two main actors, the United States and Israel, had not been invited.

Nothing new on the Gaza front, except ongoing pounding of the enclave from the air with the catastrophic humanitarian consequences it entails. Skirmishes in the North. Netanyahu threatens Hezbollah with dire consequences if it dares join the war. Further American forces are deploying to the war zone.

Israel's warning that northern Gaza should be evacuated led to a massive exodus, with no place for residents to go (Egypt is keeping its borders closed) except for a growing tent city in the southern part of the Gaza Strip near the Khan Yunis refugee camp. For the desperate evacuees this is a reminder, as the present exodus brings them near a camp of refugees from the first Arab-Israeli war. It is remarkable that the neighboring Arab countries refuse to open their borders to the desperate Palestinians.

The most recent estimates set the number of hostages at 212. In Jenin, in the West Bank, a group of alleged Hamas terrorists reportedly made plans to capture hostages, as on October 7. They were arrested in time.

While the first humanitarian convoy of trucks entered Gaza yesterday, it remains unclear what the present situation is. It seems that the seventeen trucks that comprised today's humanitarian convoy have not yet crossed into Gaza. It is probably related to the reported "accidental" shelling of an Egyptian position at the crossing by Israeli tank. Hamas is getting its